

THE BLACK PANTHER

INTERCOMMUNAL NEWS SERVICE

PUBLISHED WEEKLY BY THE BLACK PANTHER PARTY

copyright © 1975 by Huey P. Newton

VOL. XIII NO. 4 SATURDAY, MARCH 15, 1975

25¢



INSIDE

• "SOMETHING DIFFERENT IN OAKLAND" PAGE 3

• BLACK COPS WELCOME B.P.P. SUPPORT PAGE 5

• DAVID DU BOIS: "COURAGE TO WIN" CENTERFOLD

• LAND REFORM IN ETHIOPIA PAGE 19

20 MILLION AMERICANS COULD...BUT DON'T

ARE YOU ELIGIBLE FOR FOOD STAMPS?



Eligibility for food stamps reviewed. A public service by THE BLACK PANTHER.



(Washington, D.C.) — In the midst of skyrocketing unemployment, economy shattering inflation/recession and spiraling food prices, comes a report from the Senate Select Nutrition Committee charging that the restrictive policies of the U.S. Department of Agriculture are preventing the national food stamp program from meeting the needs of millions of American people.

The report, released last week, estimates that there are 20 million Americans eligible for food stamps but aren't receiving them.

The Committee report charges that the Agriculture Department's requirements for verification of income, a complicated 15 step adjustment process used to establish food stamp eligibility, cost and quantity received, "are unnecessarily burdensome and not justified." The report says that the requirement guidelines are an inconvenience to both poor people and state officials who must administer the program.

In regard to eligibility, *Newsweek* magazine, in its February 24 issue, writes: "In most places, extensive documentation is required — driver's license, social security cards for all members of the household, birth certificates of all children, voter registration card, rent receipts, bank statements and cancelled checks. Failure to produce one required document can mean having to start all over again."

The Senate Committee recommended that the eligibility certification in its present form

CONTINUED ON PAGE 16